FRANMARINE UNDERWATER SERVICES PTY LTD

TOWING AND PUSHING

Procedure

MV ROHANI | UVI: 457394 | Class 2C

Marine Order 504 (2024) — Schedule 1 Compliance

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DOCUMENT CONTROL

Revision History

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Approval

Role	Name	Date
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Review Frequency

This document shall be reviewed at least every 12 months, or sooner following a significant incident, change of operations, vessel modification, or change in applicable legislation.

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1. PURPOSE AND SCOPE

This procedure establishes the requirements for the safe conduct of towing and pushing operations by MV Rohani. The vessel has a rated bollard pull of 6 tonnes and is used to tow or push barges, pontoons, and other floating plant to and from work sites.

1.1 Regulatory Reference

Marine Order 504 (2024), Schedule 1, Clause 11(5). COLREGs Rules 3(g), 24 (towing lights/shapes). Marine Order 30 (COLREGs). Port authority towing regulations where applicable.

2. PRE-TOWING ASSESSMENT

Before commencing any towing or pushing operation, the master shall assess and confirm the following:

(a) The weight, dimensions, and condition of the tow — confirm the tow is within the vessel's capability (6t bollard pull).

(b) The intended route — prepare a passage plan per FUS-SMS-ROH-05K considering the combined manoeuvrability of the vessel and tow.

(c) Weather and sea conditions — towing significantly reduces vessel manoeuvrability. Conservative weather limits apply.

(d) Tidal conditions — assess current strength and direction along the route.

(e) Traffic — notify Marine Rescue and/or port authority VTS if towing within a port or harbour area.

(f) Towing gear condition — inspect tow lines, shackles, bollards/bitts, and bridle arrangements for wear or damage.

(g) Communications — confirm communications between the vessel and any personnel on the tow (if applicable).

(h) Navigation lights and day shapes — rig towing lights and display the correct day shapes per COLREGs Rule 24.

3. TOWING PROCEDURE

(a) Secure the tow line to the vessel's towing bollard/bitt. Use appropriate chafing protection where the line passes over gunwales or fairleads.

(b) For alongside towing (pushing): secure the tow alongside using bow, stern, and spring lines. Fender the contact area.

(c) For stern towing: pay out sufficient tow line length to achieve a safe catenary and avoid shock loading. As a guide, the tow line length should be at least 3 times the combined length of the vessel and tow in sheltered waters.

(d) Commence the tow at slow speed, gradually increasing power until the tow line is taut and the tow is moving.

(e) Maintain a steady speed appropriate to conditions. Avoid sudden changes in speed or heading.

(f) Monitor the tow line continuously for chafing, fouling, or excessive load.

(g) Maintain a listening watch on VHF Ch 16 and the relevant port working channel.

4. PUSHING PROCEDURE

(a) Approach the barge or pontoon at dead slow speed.

(b) Make contact with the bow fender/push knees.

(c) Apply power gradually and evenly.

(d) Maintain positive contact — do not allow the vessel and tow to separate during manoeuvring.

(e) When repositioning, reduce to dead slow before breaking contact.

5. EMERGENCY PROCEDURES

(a) If the tow line parts: recover the tow line immediately to prevent fouling the propellers. Re-establish the tow when conditions permit.

(b) If the tow becomes uncontrollable: release the tow line (slip the tow) and stand clear. Notify Marine Rescue/VTS immediately.

(c) An axe or line cutter shall be readily accessible near the towing bollard to enable emergency release of the tow line.

6. COMPLETION

(a) Bring the tow to the destination at dead slow speed.

(b) Secure the tow to the berth, mooring, or anchor point before disconnecting the tow line.

(c) Remove towing lights and day shapes.

(d) Inspect the tow line and gear for damage. Record any defects in the vessel logbook.

7. REFERENCES

FUS-SMS-ROH-05K Passage Planning

FUS-SMS-ROH-05F Navigation and Watchkeeping

FUS-SMS-ROH-05J Radio Watch

Marine Order 30 (Prevention of Collisions)